

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 3  
♥ A K 9 7 5  
♦ Q 9 5  
♣ 6 3

♠ K Q 6

♥ Q 10 4

♦ J

♣ A J 9 8 4 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 9 7 5 2

♥ 8 2

♦ 10 7 6 4 3

♣ K 7

♠ A 10 4

♥ J 6 3

♦ A K 8 2

♣ Q 10 5

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
| 1♥       | 2♣    | Pass | 1♦    |
| Pass     | 3NT   |      | 3♣    |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

3NT by North  
then try to run the ♣Q.

[showcards W:H8 N:HJ]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥8, dummy played the ♥J

Play the ♥9. North played dummy's ♥J to tempt you to cover. Don't fall for it.

Partner's lead of a high spot card shows no honors in the suit. That added to the fact that North bid Notrump after you had mentioned ♥s is pretty good evidence that North holds at least ♥Q x x.

To maintain communication with partner your best hope is to duck the first ♥, but to signal encouragement with the ♥9.

North wins the first trick easily, but must try to establish ♣s. He will enter dummy with the ♠A,

Not today. Partner takes the ♣K and returns his ♥2 to your four winners.

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 9 3  
 ♥ K Q J 5  
 ♦ 9 3  
 ♣ Q J 10

♠ 8 4

♥ 9 7 3

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ A 6 5 3



♠ A 10 7 5

♥ A 8 2

♦ K Q

♣ K 8 7 4

♠ K 6 2

♥ 10 6 4

♦ A J 6 5 4

♣ 9 2

West

North

East

South

2♣

Pass

2♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

1NT with either 5-4-2-2 or 5-4-3-1 distribution.

[showcards W:C9 N:CT]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♣9, dummy played the ♣10

Play the ♣6.

Partner's ♣9 is likely from a short suit. If it is a singleton, you should take the ♣A immediately and return the suit for a ruff. If it is a doubleton, you should NOT take your ♣A now, but should hope partner can get the lead and play his second ♣ to your Ace so you can give him the ruff.

You can figure out which it is.

If it is a singleton, then East must hold 5 ♣s. But you know East has 4 ♠s, so if he also has 5 ♣s then he only has 4 red cards, and he would not have opened

So partner's ♣9 is not a singleton, and you should wait. Declarer then runs dummy's ♠Q. Partner wins the ♠K, returns his OTHER ♣ to your ♣A, and NOW you give him the ruff. He takes the ♦A for down 1.

**Board 3**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 3

♥ 10 2

♦ Q J 8 6 4 2

♣ 8 3

♠ 6 5 2

♥ J 9 8

♦ 9 5

♣ K J 10 9 7



♠ Q J 9 7

♥ K Q 6 5 3

♦ 10

♣ A 6 4

♠ A K 4

♥ A 7 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ Q 5 2

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Dbl

Pass

2♣

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

♥s to enter dummy and he will never get to enjoy those two ♣ winners.

[showcards W:HT N:HJ]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥10, dummy played the ♥J

Play the ♥6.

Declarer gets two ♥ winners whether you play one of your honors on this trick or not. So why does it matter what you do?

Suppose you cover with your ♥Q. South will win his ♥A, then play ♣s until your ♣A is forced out on the third round. He can then force an entry to dummy in the ♥ suit to reach the two ♣ winners.

Now suppose you duck the ♥J. Again South will push ♣s, and again you hold up until the third round. Ahh, what a difference. Now declarer cannot use the

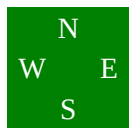
**Board 4**

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 3  
 ♥ A J 3  
 ♦ K 10 9 2  
 ♣ 9 7 3

♠ Q  
 ♥ 10 9 6 5 2  
 ♦ J 8 6 3  
 ♣ 6 4 2



♠ 7 5 4 2  
 ♥ K Q  
 ♦ A 5  
 ♣ K J 10 8 5

♠ K 10 9 8 6  
 ♥ 8 7 4  
 ♦ Q 7 4  
 ♣ A Q

| West                                               | North | East | South |
|----------------------------------------------------|-------|------|-------|
|                                                    |       | 1♣   | 1♠    |
| 2NT                                                | Pass  | 3NT  |       |
| All Pass                                           |       |      |       |
| 3NT by West<br>contract could no longer be beaten. |       |      |       |

[showcards W:SQ N:S2]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠Q, a low card was played from dummy,

Play the ♠K.

It seems that perhaps you should play low and let partner's ♠Q force out West's ♠A. Then, when you get the lead with a high ♣ you can force out West's ♠J. Get the lead with your other high ♣ and set the contract with ♠s.

Suppose you try that. Play low on the first ♠. West will also play low and North will be left holding the trick, and also holding the bag! With no more ♠s North will have to play one of the other three suits, and that is just what West wants to have happen. The

Now do it the right way. Play your ♠K on partner's ♠Q. Assume West takes the trick, although it doesn't matter whether he wins the first one or holds up. When you win your first ♣ drive out West's ♠J. When you win your second ♣ trick your ♠s will be good. If you overtake the first trick the contract can no longer be made.

Notice that West will always make two ♠ tricks, so your overtake costs nothing.

**Board 5**

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 8 7 5 4 2

♥ Q 10 4

♦ 8 3

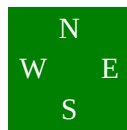
♣ A 6

♠ Q J 10

♥ A 7

♦ A K 7 5

♣ 10 7 5 3



♠ 9 3

♥ J 8 6 5 2

♦ J 10 9 4

♣ K 4

♠ A 6

♥ K 9 3

♦ Q 6 2

♣ Q J 9 8 2

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

East (your wonderful partner) will win the first ♣ and return his final ♠ to dummy's ♠A.

North will have to keep working on ♣s, but now you can win the ♣A and play your ♠K, dropping North's ♠Q, and your other three good ♠s.

Just like the previous deal, North gets two ♠ tricks either way, but one way he makes an overtrick, the other way he goes down 2.

[showcards W:S9 N:S6]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠9, dummy played the ♠6

Play the ♠8 (to signal encouragement).

You could easily win the ♠K, then play a small ♠ to drive out dummy's ♠A. But North bid Notrump over your 2 ♠ overcall, so he surely holds ♠ Q J 10. So when you get the lead with your one ♣A entry you can establish your ♠s, but you won't get into the lead to cash them.

Look what happens when you duck the first trick. North will win the trick with his ♠10, and start on dummy's ♣ suit.

**Board 6**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 10 6 4  
 ♥ Q J 10  
 ♦ A K 6  
 ♣ 9 4 2

♠ 7 2

♥ 8 4 3

♦ 9 5 4

♣ A 8 7 5 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ K 9 5

♥ A K 9 7 5 2

♦ Q 8 3

♣ 6

♠ A Q 8 3

♥ 6

♦ J 10 7 2

♣ K Q J 10

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       | 1♥   | Dbl   |
| Rdbl     | 2♣    | Pass | 3♣    |
| 3♥       | Pass  | 4♥   |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4♥ by East  
 next two ♠s, then leads a third ♠ for you to ruff. Down 1.

[showcards W:CK N:C2]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♣K, dummy played low

Overtake partner's ♣K with the ♣A.

You are pretty sure partner would not have supported your ♣s unless he had 4 of them, which means it is very likely that East has a singleton. (he might even be void)

So if you are to set this contract partner is going to have to have some ♠ winners. It might not matter, but it also might be vital that the first ♠ lead comes from your side of the table so after you overtake with the ♣A you switch to the ♠7.

Partner loves it - whatever East does South takes the